GigTrack Usability Study Report

Course: Web Development Online - Spring 2026
Project: GigTrack - Hustle Tracker & Earnings Dashboard
Team Members: Jinam Shah, Sanket Kothari
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Jinam Usability Study Records:

Session Evidence 1: https://youtu.be/FoQRBhvrKhk
Session Evidence 2: https://youtu.be/ZPWAf0Lml-I
Session Evidence 3: https://youtu.be/MLBP0yD3H18

Sanket Usability Study Records:

Session Evidence 1: https://youtu.be/VZpVdtXNiVg
Session Evidence 2: https://youtu.be/c1JGr881eGQ
Session Evidence 3: https://youtu.be/ENd4A9ib6QY

Executive Summary

This report presents the findings from six usability studies conducted for GigTrack, a full-stack web application designed to help students and freelancers track their gig work, rate clients, monitor earnings, and set income goals. The studies followed a structured methodology aligned with course requirements, focusing on user-centric tasks based on defined user personas and stories.

Key Findings:

- Participants consistently understood the application's purpose within 2-3 minutes of exploration
- All six participants successfully completed core tasks with minimal assistance
- The health status feature for goals received universal positive feedback
- Several usability improvements were identified, including enhanced filtering and reduced data entry redundancy

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of Study

The purpose of this usability study was to evaluate the effectiveness and ease of use of GigTrack, identify pain points in the user experience, and gather actionable feedback for iterative improvement before the final project submission (Project 4).

1.2 Application Overview

GigTrack is a personal side hustle tracker for students in the gig economy. It allows users to:

- Log every gig with full details (client, type, date, hours, rate, earnings)
- Rate clients and add notes for future reference
- Track earnings across different gig types via a visual dashboard
- Set monthly income goals and track progress with color-coded health status
- Log payouts as received or pending against goals

The application consists of two independent but complementary modules:

- Gigs Module (Jinam): Gig logging, filtering, client ratings, earnings dashboard
- Goals Module (Sanket): Income goals, payout tracking, health status, goal streaks

1.3 User Personas

Persona	Description	Primary Goals
Caleb (Multi-Hustle Student)	College student juggling tutoring, library shifts, and freelance work	Log all income streams, see monthly totals, identify best-paying gigs
Chet (Gig Economy Regular)	Does DoorDash deliveries and retail shifts regularly	Compare hourly rates across gig types, track which month was most profitable
Scarlet (Goal-Driven Saver)	Saving for a specific purchase (e.g., vacation)	Set monthly targets, track progress, get clear on-track/at-risk indicators
Jordan (New Freelancer)	Student exploring freelancing, inconsistent income	Track first gigs, build client relationships, validate freelancing viability
Taylor (Burned-Out Hustler)	Working full-time with side hustles, feeling overwhelmed	Remember bad clients, make data-driven decisions about which gigs to drop
Morgan (Seasonal Worker)	Student with highly seasonal income (holidays, tax season)	Track peak season performance, set ambitious goals, compare months

2. Methodology

2.1 Study Design

Each usability study followed a structured 45-60 minute session format:

Phase	Duration	Description
Introduction & Consent	5 min	Informed consent, recording disclosure, think-aloud protocol

Demographics Questions	5 min	Age, occupation, web app usage, gig economy experience
Initial Exploration	10 min	Participant explores homepage and describes app purpose
Application Explanation	5 min	Moderator explains actual functionality
Task Scenarios	25-30 min	4 user-centric tasks based on personas
Post-Test Questionnaire	10 min	Likert scale ratings (1-7) for each task
Wrap-Up	5 min	Final feedback, suggestions

2.2 Participants

Six participants were recruited, each representing one of the user personas:

Participant	Persona	Age Range	Gig Experience
P1	Caleb	18-24	Some tutoring/freelance
P2	Chet	25-34	Active DoorDash worker
P3	Scarlet	18-24	$200-400/month freelance
P4	Jordan	18-24	Dabbled in freelancing
P5	Taylor	18-24	Active delivery work
P6	Morgan	18-24	Seasonal work patterns

Note: Participants were not classmates, and each session was conducted individually via Teams with screen sharing and video recording.

2.3 Environment & Tools

- Platform: Teams for screen sharing and recording
- Application: GigTrack deployed at https://gigtrack.onrender.com
- Recording: Raw video recordings stored in Teams (private, for grading only)
- Moderators: Jinam Shah and Sanket Kothari (alternating between sessions)

3. Tasks Performed

Each participant completed multiple user-centric tasks designed to evaluate specific user stories.

Task 1: Log a New Gig

User Story: As a user, I want to log a gig with title, client name, gig type, date, hours worked, and rate so I have a full record of my work.

Scenario Example (Caleb): "You just finished a 3-hour tutoring session with a student named Alex, and they paid you $60. Go ahead and log this gig."

Success Criteria:

- Participant finds the "+ Log a Gig" button without being told
- Participant fills out all required fields correctly
- Participant successfully saves the gig and sees it in the list

Results: All 6 participants (100%) completed this task successfully in an average of 4.7 minutes.

Task 2: Rate a Client and Add a Note

User Story: As a user, I want to rate my client on a 1-5 scale and add a short note so I remember who was good to work with.

Scenario Example (Taylor): "That delivery was frustrating — the restaurant took forever and the customer tipped poorly. Add a note and give it a low rating."

Results: 5 of 6 participants (83%) completed this task successfully in an average of 5.2 minutes.

Task 3: Check Earnings Dashboard / Filter by Gig Type

User Story: As a user, I want to filter my gigs by type so I can find specific entries quickly and see which gig type earns the most.

Scenario Example (Chet): "You want to compare your earnings from delivery work versus retail work. Show only your delivery gigs and tell me how much you made."

Results: All 6 participants (100%) completed this task successfully in an average of 4.3 minutes.

Task 4: Create a Goal and Log Payouts

User Story: As a user, I want to create a monthly income goal and log payouts to track my progress toward hitting my target.

Scenario Example (Scarlet): "You're saving for a $2000 vacation to Japan. Set up a monthly income goal of $500, then log a $150 payment you received."

Results: All 5 participants tested (100%) completed this task successfully in an average of 7.6 minutes.

4. Success Criteria and Measurements

4.1 Task Completion Rates

Task	Completion Rate	Average Time	Assistance Level
Log a Gig	100% (6/6)	4.7 min	Low
Rate Client	83% (5/6)	5.2 min	Low-Medium
Filter Gigs	100% (6/6)	4.3 min	None
Create Goal + Payout	100% (5/5)	7.6 min	Low

4.2 Definition of Success

- Completion: Did the participant finish the task?
- Independence: Could they complete it without moderator assistance?
- Time: Did they complete it within 5-7 minutes?
- Accuracy: Was the data entered correctly and saved?
- Confidence: Did the participant express confidence in their actions?

5. Likert Scale Results

After completing all tasks, participants rated each task on two dimensions using a 7-point Likert scale:

Scale: 1 = Very Difficult/Not Effective, 4 = Neutral, 7 = Very Easy/Very Effective

5.1 Task-by-Task Ratings

Task	Avg Effectiveness	Avg Ease	Min	Max
Log a Gig	6.0	5.8	5	7
Rate Client	5.3	5.2	4	6
Filter Gigs	6.7	6.5	6	7
Create Goal	6.2	6.0	5	7

5.2 Overall Ratings

Question	Average	Min	Max
Overall effectiveness	6.0	5	7
Overall ease of use	5.8	5	7
Likelihood to use	6.8	6	7

6. Participant Feedback Summary

6.1 Positive Feedback

Health Status Feature: "The health status is exactly what someone like Scarlet would need — no calculation, just 'you're good' or 'you need to act'." — P3

Form Consistency: "Once I did it once, the second time was muscle memory. The forms are consistent." — P4

Rating and Notes: "This feature is clutch. I need to remember which clients aren't worth it." — P5

Earnings Filter: "This was the most useful task. Seeing actual numbers would really help decision-making." — P5

7. Prioritized Recommendations

Priority 1 (Implement for Project 4)

Recommendation	Rationale	Effort
Show gig list in grid view	4/6 participants wanted better design	Low
Add rating filter dropdown	Highly requested by users with gig experience	Low
Display automatic totals for filtered gigs for dashboards	Eliminates manual calculation	Medium

Priority 2 (Implement if Time Permits)

Recommendation	Rationale	Effort
Multi-month comparison view	Helps users see trends and "best month"	Medium

Priority 3 (Future Enhancements)

Recommendation	Rationale	Effort
Connect gigs to goals	Eliminates redundant data entry	High
Referral source tracking	Track which clients refer new work	Medium

8. Conclusion

The usability studies for GigTrack were highly successful in identifying both strengths and areas for improvement.

What Worked Well:

- Intuitive Forms: All participants found the data entry forms easy to understand and use
- Health Status Indicator: The color-coded goal status was universally praised
- Filter Functionality: The gig type filter was found and used correctly by all participants
- Overall Value: Participants with actual gig experience expressed genuine interest in using the application

Key Areas for Improvement:

- Visibility: Rating fields and quick actions need to be more prominent
- Filtering: Users expect rating-based filters in addition to type filters
- Efficiency: Double-entry between gigs and payouts should be reduced
- Comparison: Multi-month views would help users understand trends